

Earning the right click, not the most clicks

Part 3 of 3 — Creative Design · ads/ad-320x50.png (+ @2x) · ads/ad-250x250.png · ads/ad-1080x1920.png · HTML sources and ads/message-match.md alongside · static, under 100 KB each

Decision. One concept in three sizes: a real question from the test labelled as a sample, plus the honest promise "Free IQ test · 12 questions · ~5 min · no payment", in the landing page's own colours and type.

Metric. Accounts per impression = CTR × post-click Account CVR, attributed on click-through only (view-through credit inflates display CPA); a creative is judged on the accounts it produces, never on its CTR.

Trade-off. The promise says "no payment", never "free score" or "instant results": in the control the range is shown after the free account, and a claim the entry screen cannot keep is an unavailable offer under Google's misrepresentation policy and a bait-and-switch.

OBJECTIVE

Part 3 scales beyond Search into programmatic display, where intent is colder, so the creative must qualify the click for people who will finish 12 questions and create the free account, and promise exactly what the entry screen delivers. Guardrails: viewability, invalid-traffic share and frequency, because a display CPA win can be a placement-quality artefact. The category's incumbent script ("Are you smarter than the average American? Certified IQ test") belongs to documented subscription traps (Which?, BBB, TINA.org), so none of its vocabulary is borrowed. All three promote the control; a 12-vs-8 test would run under count-neutral copy; "~5 min" is an estimate until measured.

320 × 50 — MOBILE BANNER · "FREE IQ TEST" · "12 QUESTIONS · ~5 MIN · NO PAYMENT" · "START"

Placement. The cheapest, noisiest mobile slot. **Hook.** At this size a puzzle is unreadable and text under about 14 CSS px is hard to read, so the banner carries only the promise and the qualification: three facts that filter for people willing to spend five minutes, and the word users fear, payment, taken off the table. **Continuity.** It repeats the landing's eyebrow line and adds "no payment", which the landing's block carries; the account boundary it has no room for is the first block under the landing headline, before question one. **Interpretation.** Exported at 1× (320×50) and 2× (640×100) because a 1× asset blurs on high-DPR phones; this size inflates CTR with mis-taps, so it is judged on post-click account rate, never on CTR.

250 × 250 — SQUARE · "WHICH TILE COMPLETES THE GRID?" · THE REAL QUESTION 1 · FACTS · "START THE TEST"

Placement. In-content square (low-supply; the composition also fits 300×250). **Hook.** Puzzle-in-ad is the hook this category runs on: intelligence framing and puzzle-first visuals recur across the IQ creatives sampled in the Google Ads Transparency Center and the Meta Ad Library [COMPETITOR OBSERVATION]. It is honest here because the tile is question 1 of the test, labelled "Sample · Q1 of 12", with no clickable-looking options: Google's misleading-ad-design rule bans fake answer buttons, and Meta's personal-attributes rule bans implying the viewer's intelligence, so there is no "Are you smart enough?", only the question. **Continuity.** The user meets the same grid two taps later, and the gate screen's sample explanation shows how it is solved. **Interpretation.** Judged on accounts per impression; the footer "Free IQ test · 12 questions · ~5 min · no payment" is checked at pixel level so that every word renders.

1080 × 1920 — FULL-SCREEN VERTICAL · SAMPLE QUESTION 1 · 12 / ~5 MIN / 4 AREAS · "START THE TEST" · BOUNDARY LINE

Placement. Full-screen interstitials and Stories. **Hook.** The sample item, the three facts, the CTA and the sentence that prevents the post-click surprise: "Free, no payment: all 12 questions and how many you got right. Free account (email only, no password): IQ range and rank. No payment, ever. Not a clinical IQ assessment." Key elements sit in the safe area (72 px sides, 270 px top, 670 px bottom, clear of platform chrome); no bell curve with the viewer's marker pre-placed (an implied result). **Continuity.** Everything on it is on the landing page. **Interpretation.** My hypothesis is that this creative produces accounts per impression rather than curiosity clicks, because whoever taps it already knows there is an account step; the boundary sentence costs raw CTR on purpose and is the first hold-out I would run, keeping it unless the 95% interval on accounts per impression lies below the version without it.

REJECTED, AND WHERE AI HELPED

Rejected: "No signup" (an account exists), "Free score" and "Instant results" (true only after the account), "Scientifically accurate", "Certified", "Only 1% can solve this", countdowns, any implied result for the viewer. **Where AI helped:** Claude Code researched current IQ-test ads and the policy language, built and exported the creatives at exact pixel sizes, produced the message-match matrix and found the clipped 250×250 footer by scanning the exported pixels; the concept, the promise line and the rejection list were my calls.

Labels: [EVIDENCE] · [COMPETITOR OBSERVATION] · [INFERENCE] · [HYPOTHESIS]. No CTR or conversion benchmark is quoted.